

more money, time, and frustration in the long run if you go it alone.

Not sure when to DIY and when to hire out? Ask yourself these questions before making a final decision:

- Do I have the basic skills required to complete this project?
- How much time will it take me?
- How expensive are the tools needed? Is it possible to borrow or rent them?
- Do I feel completely confident I can complete this project without any (or very minimal) mistakes?
- What does my research tell me in terms of project difficulty? Is this something people normally hire out, or is it an easy DIY?
- What do the laws of my city or county allow me to do? (i.e., Do I need a permit?)

Depending on your answers, you may decide it's best to call a professional. They *are* called that for a reason!

3. USE CONTRACTORS YOU TRUST

When you call in a contractor, it is incredibly important to find and use one you trust. As frustrating as it is, there are handymen who scam their customers, do shoddy work, and profit from natural disasters with exorbitant price hikes. You do not want to be on the receiving end of one of them.

Even if you're not in the middle of a home repair right now, it's good to gather as many word-of-mouth contacts as you can to file away for later. Ask friends and family who they've used in the past and would recommend, and if you want to go a step further, check with the Better Business Bureau